

Post Game Report: Emirates NBA Cup Final - Bucks v. Thunder (12/17)

Comprehensive Report:

The Milwaukee Bucks defeated the Oklahoma City Thunder by a score of 97-81 to claim their first Emirates NBA Cup title in franchise history. While the Bucks only led by 1 point at the half, a 26-14 3rd quarter proved decisive. It was a strong defensive display from the Bucks as they held the Thunder to their lowest point total of the season, holding their offense to just 15.6% shooting from 3 (32 attempts). Giannis Antetokounmpo solidified his superstar status yet again, posting a monster 26-19-10 triple-double in almost 37 minutes played. The eventual tournament MVP also added 2 steals and 3 blocks. It was a less-than-stellar night for the superstar on the opposing team, as Shai Gilgeous-Alexander finished with 21 points on 8-24 shooting and tied for a team-worst -17 plus/minus. While the Thunder struggled from behind the arc, the Bucks were firing on all cylinders, shooting 42.5% from 3 on 40 attempts. The largest contributor to this barrage was Damian Lillard, who is not shy when the lights are the brightest. He connected on 5 of his 10 3-pointers, on his way to a 23-point outing. Both teams had key absences, including Khris Middleton and Chet Holmgren, and while the Bucks' shooting did not miss a beat, the Thunder would have liked to have Holmgren's presence as the Bucks amassed 9 offensive rebounds and 28 points in the paint.

Link to Interactive Shot Chart Dashboard -> [Dashboard Link](#)

- **The dashboard includes all shot locations from the game, as well as a comprehensive tooltip, so when you hover over each shot, the shooter, closest defender, shot type, shot region, etc., will be displayed.**
- **Can be filtered to see all shots from individual players, all shots against certain players as the closest defender, shots by quarter, shots by shot clock, etc. All of these filters have an adjusted graphic at the bottom, so no matter what is selected, the corresponding FG%, 3P%, and average Q Sq will be displayed.**

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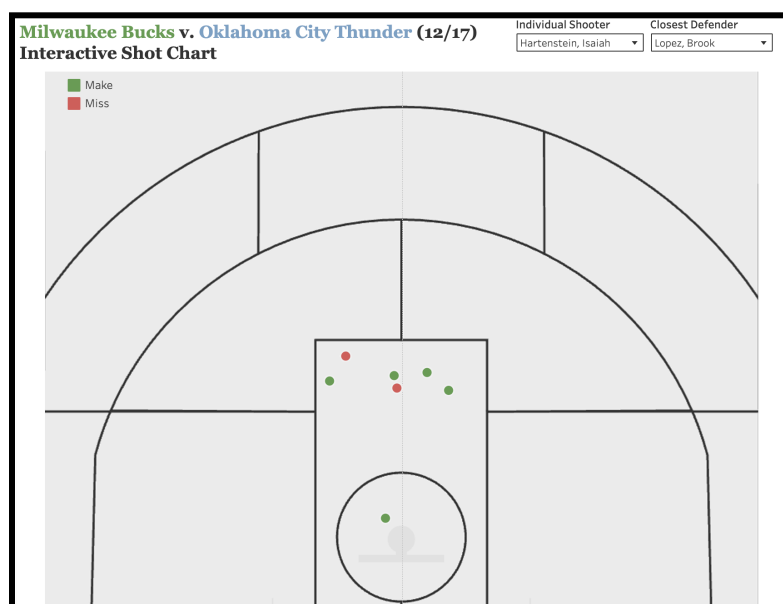
Insight #1: Brook Lopez was scored on the most, with 12 made FG as the nearest defender.

player_nba_closestDef <chr>	FG_allowed <int>
Lopez, Brook	12
Hartenstein, Isaiah	8
Gilgeous-Alexander, Shai	6
Williams, Jalen	5
Green, AJ	4
Mitchell, Ajay	4
Wallace, Cason	4
Lillard, Damian	3
Prince, Taurean	3
Williams, Kenrich	3

Of these 12 FG, 5 were made by Isaiah Hartenstein.

player_nba_shooter <chr>	makes_against_lopez <int>
Hartenstein, Isaiah	5
Gilgeous-Alexander, Shai	3
Williams, Jalen	3
Dort, Luguentz	1

From our interactive shot chart, we can see that 4 of these makes came from the key, while only one came at the rim.



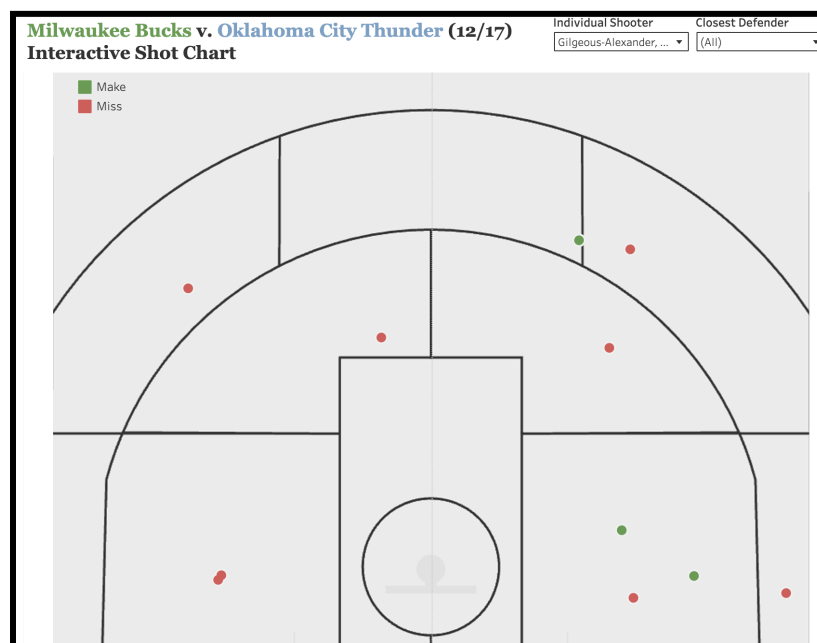
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Insight #2: This is a chart of the top 10 players who outperformed the average shot qSq of all of their FG attempts in this game. Each player listed took 5 or more field goal attempts, and attempts where the shooter was fouled were removed.

One observation could be that amongst this list, Damian Lillard took the most low-percentage shots on average, but converted above an expected rate.

player_nba_shooter <chr>	total_shots <int>	fg_made <dbl>	fg_pct <dbl>	avg_qsq <dbl>	fg_qsq_diff <dbl>
Green, AJ	5	3	60.00000	47.91953	12.0804678
Trent Jr., Gary	9	5	55.55556	48.20849	7.3470690
Lillard, Damian	12	6	50.00000	45.07140	4.9286016
Hartenstein, Isaiah	11	6	54.54545	53.96845	0.5770075
Antetokounmpo, Giannis	18	9	50.00000	55.13705	-5.1370541
Williams, Jalen	20	8	40.00000	45.54167	-5.5416691
Lopez, Brook	12	5	41.66667	50.93905	-9.2723814
Gilgeous-Alexander, Shai	24	8	33.33333	50.20916	-16.8758243
Joe, Isaiah	7	2	28.57143	50.96885	-22.3974192
Portis, Bobby	9	2	22.22222	47.89454	-25.6723210

Another observation is Shai Gilgeous-Alexander shooting 8-24 with a 50.2% average qSq on his shots. **Below is a chart grabbed from the interactive shot chart, showing all of his attempts in this game with the complex shot type set to “stepbacks”**. He shot 3-11 from these attempts, and 7 of them came from the midrange. One adjustment could be stressing getting to the rim or taking more set shots.



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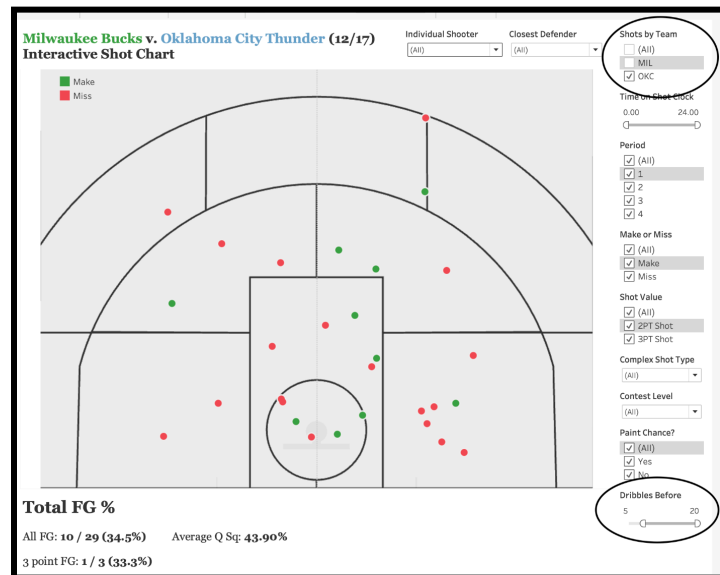
Insight #3: The Bucks shot 17-40 (42.5%) from 3, while the Thunder shot 5-32 (15.6%) from 3.

Statistic	Bucks	Thunder
3 point %	42.5%	15.6%
3 point % on attempts labelled "heavily contested"	43.5% (23 attempts)	30.0% (10 attempts)
Avg. Closest Defender Distance on all 3pt attempts	6.13 feet	6.89 feet
Most common 3pt Complex Shot Types (#)	1. Catch and Shoot (18) 2. Catch and Shoot relocating (10) 3. Stepback (5)	1. Catch and Shoot (15) 2. Stepback (5) 3. Shake and raise (3)
Average Release Time on 3's	1.39 seconds	2.01 seconds

The Thunder were notably cold from behind the arc, yet they had more space on their attempts than the Bucks, at almost 7 feet of space per attempt. The complex shot types offer an interesting finding, as 28 of the Bucks' 3s came from a catch-and-shoot type attempt. This could suggest better ball movement and spacing, and the box score supports this idea, as the Bucks almost doubled the Thunder in assists, posting 25 to the Thunder's 13. The average release time jumps out as well, as the Bucks got their 3pt attempts much quicker than the Thunder, by an average of 0.62 seconds.

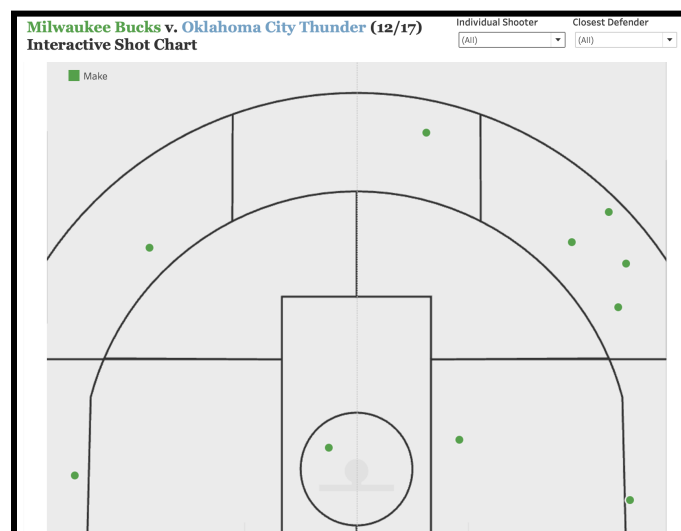
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Insight #4: The Thunder played a lot more isolation ball.



Using our interactive dashboard again, when setting the FG attempts to OKC and using Dribbles Before to show us only attempts with 5 or more dribbles, the Thunder shot a poor 34.5%, with only 3 of those shots coming behind the arc. While the Bucks shot an even worse 25.0% on similar attempts, they only took 12 to OKC's 29.

Insight #5: A look at all of Giannis' 10 assists.



Of Giannis' 10 assists, 6 had the complex shot type of a catch-and-shoot. The Bucks' shooters did a great job of filling and replacing, or providing an option for Giannis when he drove to the basket.